

Preston Mantel

Ph.D. Candidate, Department of Finance
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Education

Ph.D. in Finance, University of Cincinnati 2022–Present

Dissertation: *Essays on Market Microstructure Frictions and Retail Investors*

Committee: Mehmet Saglam (Chair)

GPA: 3.98/4.0

B.S. in Mechanical Engineering, Purdue University 2014–2018

Minors: Computer Science, Global Engineering Studies

GPA: 3.7/4.0

Study Abroad: Universidad Carlos III de Madrid, Spain Spring 2017

Research Interests

Market Microstructure, Retail Investor Protection, Regulation, Price Discovery, Market Quality

Working Papers

Mantel, Preston. “Taker Delays and Liquidity Provision in Prediction Markets.” Working Paper, May 2026.

- Studies Polymarket policy changes introducing and removing taker delays in crypto markets.
- Uses BBO quotes and on-chain fills to estimate effects on spreads, liquidity, and maker entry.
- Finds that taker delays narrow quoted spreads, increase maker entry, and interact with rebates.

Mantel, Preston. “When Lots Matter: SEC Round Lot Modernization and Liquidity.” Working Paper, November 2025. Available at SSRN: <https://ssrn.com/abstract=5757242>

- Examines market quality and trading behavior effects of SEC round lot modernization.
- Studies how round lot definitions affect trading costs by impacting NBBO spreads.
- Finds significant decreases in spreads, volatility, and latency following round lot modernization.

Mantel, Preston and Mehmet Saglam. “Democratizing or Demoralizing: Impact of Robinhood on Costs and Volatility.” Working Paper, November 2025. Available at SSRN: <https://ssrn.com/abstract=4377192>

- Studies how Robinhood’s order-collaring mechanism affects retail trading costs and volatility.
- Uses regular hours and after-hours trades to identify the impact of market order collaring.
- Finds increased retail trading costs of approximately 2 basis points, or over \$2 billion in 2020.

Mantel, Preston and Mehmet Saglam. “Market Making Counterparty Interest.” Working Paper, June 2025.

- Tests whether market makers treat institutional counterparties differently from retail flow.
- Maps proprietary institutional trades to TAQ NBBO spreads and intraday price impact.
- Replicates prior evidence and finds similar treatment across institutional counterparties.

Mantel, Preston, Mehmet Saglam, and Tugkan Tuzun (Federal Reserve). “Actively Traded ETFs.” Working Paper, June 2025.

- Examines conflicts between managers and investors using trades from actively traded ETFs.
- Shows ETF trades predict abnormal volume and associates buy trades with positive one-day returns.

- Uses short-sale activity to study whether short sellers respond to ETF-driven mispricing.

Papers Under Review

“Democratizing or Demoralizing: Impact of Robinhood on Costs and Volatility”

Submitted to the *Journal of Financial Economics*

Conference Presentations

“Democratizing or Demoralizing: Impact of Robinhood on Costs and Volatility”

- Financial Management Association Annual Meeting, Chicago, IL 2023
- The Microstructure Exchange, Stockholm, Sweden 2023
- Southern Finance Association Annual Meeting 2024

Teaching Experience

Instructor of Record, University of Cincinnati 2022–Present

- Financial Markets & Institutions (FIN 4053, 69 students) Fall 2023
Evaluation (instructor was excellent): Mean 7.11, Median 8
- Financial Modelling (FIN 4041, 49 students) Spring 2025
Evaluation (instructor was excellent): Mean 7.36, Median 8
- Financial Modelling (FIN 4041, 64 students) Summer 2025
Evaluation (instructor was excellent): Mean 7.61, Median 8

Graduate Assistant, University of Cincinnati 2022–2023

- Assisted with two finance courses

Service and Mentorship

- Advisor, Bloomberg Trading Competition student team, University of Cincinnati

Relevant Coursework

Empirical and Theoretical Corporate Finance and Asset Pricing, Bayesian and Frequentist Econometrics, Advanced Microeconomics, Big Data Analytics, Game Theory, Statistical Modelling, Forecasting

Professional Experience

Founder & COO, Digital Paradise, Indianapolis, IN Aug. 2020–Aug. 2022

Founded marketing business; grew operations to over \$100K in yearly revenue with 2+ employees.

Technology Consulting Analyst, Deloitte, Chicago, IL Aug. 2019–Aug. 2020

Clients: Nestle and Intel.

Director of Operations, Watchtower Robotics, Boston, MA Jan. 2019–Jun. 2019

Managed 15 employees and \$175K in grant income.

Technical Skills

Programming: Python, R, SQL, C, Java, HTML/CSS, MATLAB

Software: JMP, Catia, Microsoft Office, Adobe Creative Suite, L^AT_EX